

AT HOME WITH BAPU Children play around the Mahatma statue at Sabarmati Ashram

THE Rs 1,200 CRORE PLAN

Here's what the ambitious Gandhi Ashram Memorial and Precinct Development Project entails:

- Expand campus for tourist access from the current five acres to 55 acres
- Restore the ashram to how it was when Gandhi lived here between 1917 and 1930
- Restore and redevelop buildings that existed during Gandhi's time. Forty-eight of 65 original buildings to be restored
- Hold exhibitions that explain Gandhi's life as well as his message
- Create parking space for about 200 cars
- Set up a sprawling food court
- Permanently divert a portion of the main public road, which is a part of the arterial ashram road of the city
- Remove encroachments from the extended ashram campus and relocate about 250 families to alternative housing outside the ashram premises



"A similar plan was proposed 20 years ago and was backed by trustees. This project is not doing anything new. It's been adjusted for changes that have happened since"

–BIMAL PATEL, *Architect*

The general public as well as the residents of the ashram are also exercised about the government's intent to extend the tourist area. It will mean bringing down some existing structures in the extended premises and erecting new ones. For this, the government has roped in architect Bimal Patel, who has been associated with Prime Minister Narendra Modi for over two decades and is the man behind the BJP government's other grand redevelopment projects, including the Central Vista in New Delhi.